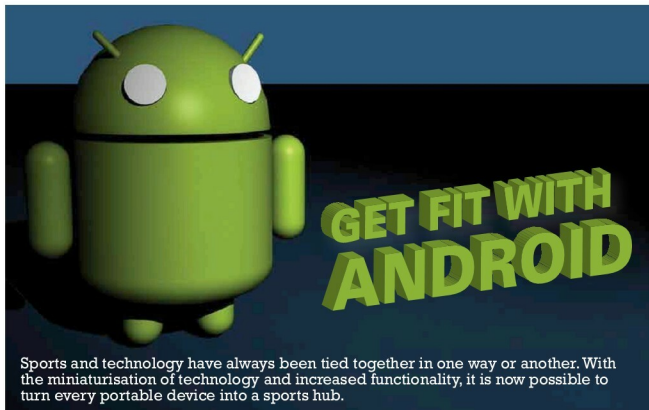




Sports and technology have always been tied together in one way or another. With the miniaturisation of technology and increased functionality, it is now possible to turn every portable device into a sports hub.

It all started in 1985, when the first cyclo-computer was detailed and invented. Till recently, such devices and tracking techniques were limited to the elite. Since then, these gadgets have shrunk, now making it possible for you to hold a cyclo computer, a heart rate monitor and a complete personal trainer in your hand. Sports computers or tracking devices made their debut with proprietary computers, courtesy of Garmin, Sigma and many others. Later on, sports tracking apps like Nike+ made their entry. However, due to their high prices, these apps weren't adopted on a wide scale. The arrival of smartphones has resulted in a paradigm shift, creating arrays of opportunity, opening new doors for untapped world and bringing sports apps to the masses.

In 2010, Android 2.3 was released—a platform cheaply available to all. With Android, developers started churning out sports applications without the need for costly hardware or show-off shoes. Thanks to some of these, we can now track and maintain our fitness regimes easily. Let's look at the best Android tracking applications that let you monitor your workout intuitively and smartly. Let us also test some of the best diet and training apps that guide you.

Track!

The very purpose of sports is to improve and compete. Tracking apps are designed to let you track your score globally, and to compare your workouts to some of the best athletes in the world. Pair these apps with a heart-rate belt, and you have a complete working 'trainer' with you.

Sports-Tracker.com: For outdoor exercise

Outdoor exercise is a great way to warm up; it is fun and refreshing, more intense, and requires more stamina than typical indoor exercise. Sports-Tracker packages a complete tracking device into an intuitive app that is available for almost all smartphone platforms—whether the old Symbian, Meego, iOS, Android or Windows Phone. The app lets you track your workout easily, offering more than 12 pre-loaded profiles for different workouts such as running, cycling, hiking, etc. All you need is an active Net connection, and if you live in a country with open GPS satellites, you can use the application without an Internet connection. The app provides precise details, with a map showing your location and speed across different routes that you tracked. The app's beautifully skinned interface adds to its intuitiveness. The home screen lists your user profile with the total number of workouts, distance tracked and other details. The centre of the screen shows the details of your latest workout, notifications from your friends (yes, this is a social tracking app) and information of dusk/dawn timings. From there, you can create a new workout, view your diary and track your complete workout statistics. You can even check out your friends' achievements, and much more. One really striking feature is the *Explore* wizard, with which you can track the workouts of people near you who use the app (provided they have made their workout public).

The developers have leveraged maps and various other features to track your route during or after the workout, which helps you discover new and unknown routes with the help of